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TAB 12



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-284-25/26, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 3/10/2026**In Control:** Environmental Health & Safety

Adoption of the Mitigated Negative Declaration and the Mitigation Monitoring and Reporting Program for the Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies Multipurpose Athletic Field Upgrades Project

Office of Environmental Health & Safety

Brief Description:

(Adoption of the Mitigated Negative Declaration and the Mitigation Monitoring and Reporting Program for the Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies Multipurpose Athletic Field Upgrades Project). Recommends review and adoption of the Mitigated Negative Declaration (MND) and Mitigation Monitoring and Reporting Program (MMRP) for the proposed Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies (VOCES) Project prepared in compliance with the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA; Public Resources Code §21000 et seq.) and State CEQA Guidelines (California Code of Regulations, Title 14, Division 6, Chapter 3 §15000 et seq.).

Furthermore, the environmental review of the Project found that there would be no significant impacts as a result of the construction and operation of the Project with the implementation of LAUSD Standard Conditions of Approval and mitigation measures.

Action Proposed:

Review and adopt the Mitigated Negative Declaration (MND) and Mitigation Monitoring and Reporting Program (MMRP) for the proposed Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies (VOCES) Project prepared in compliance with the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA; Public Resources Code §21000 et seq.) and State CEQA Guidelines (California Code of Regulations, Title 14, Division 6, Chapter 3 §15000 et seq.). An Initial Study/Mitigated Negative Declaration was prepared for the Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies Multipurpose Athletic Field Upgrades Project (Project). Environmental review of the Project found that there would be no significant impacts as a result of the construction and operation of the Project with the implementation of LAUSD Standard Conditions of Approval and mitigation measures.

Background:

On December 12, 2023, the Los Angeles Unified School District Board of Education (Board) approved the project definition to develop, design, and construct athletic field upgrades at VOCES (Board Report No. 130-23/24) for a project budget of \$7,515,769.

The proposed Project is located on a 20.7-acre school campus at 9171 Telfair Avenue in the City of Los Angeles (Board District 6, Region North). The VOCES campus was originally established in 1960 as Richard E. Byrd Middle School, was then converted to Sun Valley High School in 2009, and finally re-opened in 2020 as the VOCES Magnet as a span school serving Grades 6-12. As of the 2025-26 Electronic Capacity Assessment Review (E-CAR), the school served approximately 443 students.

The proposed Project involves the modernization and enhancement of the existing multipurpose athletic field at VOCES. The proposed Project will demolish the existing asphalt pavement and handball courts and, in its place, the proposed Project will construct a new natural grass turf regulation-size multipurpose athletic field, four new field lights up to 80 feet in height, goal posts, scoreboard, and five-tier portable bleachers to

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accommodate home and visiting team spectators for a seating capacity of approximately 370 seats. The proposed Project will also include restriping of an existing parking lot and minor upgrades to existing buildings and grounds consistent with the requirements of the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA).

The site is not listed under Section 65962.5 of the Government Code. A site-wide Phase I ESA was completed in 2006. A Preliminary Environmental Assessment-Equivalent (PEA-E) was conducted for Area B under DTSC oversight. Based on the PEA findings, DTSC issued a No Further Action determination for Areas A (classrooms) and B (field area).

The District's Office of Environmental Health & Safety (OEHS) evaluated the proposed Project to determine its potential impacts on the environment in accordance with CEQA, Public Resources Code §21000, et seq., and State CEQA Guidelines, Title 14 California Code of Regulations §15000 et seq.

Environmental review of the Project found that there would be no significant impacts as a result of the construction and operation of the Project with the implementation of LAUSD Standard Conditions of Approval. This evaluation, as documented in the Initial Study (IS), resulted in the preparation of a Negative Declaration (ND) (State Clearinghouse Number 2025100439). The District circulated the IS/ND for a 30-day public review period from October 9, 2025 to November 10, 2025. Copies of the IS/ND were available for review electronically on the OEHS and on the State Clearinghouse websites and printed copies were made available for public review at Los Angeles Unified School District Headquarters and at VOCES.

The District posted the Notice of Intent to Adopt a Negative Declaration (NOI) on the OEHS website during the public review period, mailed the NOI to all owner/occupants located within a 0.25-mile radius of the Project site, to parents/guardians of students, and published the NOI in two local newspapers (Daily News and La Opinión). The District filed the NOI with the Los Angeles County Clerk and with the State Clearinghouse for distribution to potentially affected state agencies, local agencies, tribal agencies pursuant to AB 52, and known interested parties.

At the end of the public review period, the District received three comment letters; one from the State of California Department of Transportation; one from the Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians; and one from a community member. All comments received were responded to by the District and are included in the attached Responses to Comments (RTC). In response to the letter from the Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians, the District incorporated some of their recommended mitigation measures under the tribal cultural resources section. Although these measures are not included to reduce an impact to less-than-significant, as a result of their addition, an MND, with the required MMRP, was prepared in place of the ND. The conversion of the ND to an MND did not trigger recirculation under CEQA Guidelines Section 15073 because no new, avoidable significant impact was identified.

Expected Outcomes:

Staff anticipates that the Board will review and make a determination on the attached Resolution to adopt the MND pursuant to CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines. This action is required for the Board to consider approval of the Project.

Board Options and Consequences:

A "Yes" vote to adopt the Mitigated Negative Declaration would enable the Board to consider approval of the Project.

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A “No” vote to adopt the Mitigated Negative Declaration would prevent the Board from approving the proposed Project, and the proposed Project could not proceed into construction.

Policy Implications:

This action does not change District policy. This action helps facilitate the Facilities Services Division Strategic Execution Plan and supports the goals and objectives of the School Upgrade Program (SUP). On August 24, 2021, the Board adopted an update to the SUP to integrate Measure RR funding and priorities into its operational framework and approved the Measure RR Implementation Plan (Implementation Plan) to help guide the identification of sites and development of project proposals (Board Report No. 027-21/22). The proposed Project supports the implementation of the Modernization, Upgrade and Development of High School Athletic Facilities. Projects to upgrade high school athletic facilities within each Board District fall under the SUP category of need for School Upgrades and Reconfigurations to Support Wellness, Health, Athletics, Learning, and Efficiency (WHALE).

Budget Impact:

This action does not have a budget impact.

Student Impact:

The proposed Project, once completed, will provide new and improved athletic facilities that support physical education programs, student athletic achievement, and athletic programs to benefit students of VOCES including approximately 121 student athletes. The athletic facilities upgrades will also allow schools to practice and/or host games and other school community events, which builds school pride and enhances opportunities to create a positive school culture.

Equity Impact:

Funds are allocated for each Board District based on each Board District’s proportionate share of high school enrollment and number of sports teams. Implementation of the proposed Project demonstrates the District’s commitment to support athletics at VOCES, a Title 1 school, which currently serves a student population that is 92.2% Latino and 92% of students come from low-income families.

Issues and Analysis:

Environmental review of the proposed Project found that, with the incorporation of mitigation measures, Los Angeles Unified’s Standard Conditions and Approvals, Project Design Features, as well as all applicable state, federal, and local regulations, there would be no significant impacts as a result of the Project.

The District is the “Lead Agency” as defined in the State CEQA Guidelines §§15050-15053, and the Board shall review and consider the MND, MMRP, and its supporting documents and comments.

Attachments:

Attachment A: Resolution of the Los Angeles Unified School District Board Adopting the Mitigated Negative Declaration for the Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies Major Modernization Project

Due to the file size, the following attachments may be viewed/downloaded at the links below:

Attachment B: [Initial Study/ Mitigated Negative Declaration](#)

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1H6DT429J7vzHnHVeKzEenOtn5wN-SHz6/view?usp=sharing>

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Attachment C: Initial Study/ Mitigated Negative Declaration Appendices can be viewed/downloaded from the [CEQA website](https://media.edlio.net/4c6d677b/9a9a6c77/4187132b/f46570573caa44fc90b6ead80e28d955?CEQA_website)
<[https://media.edlio.net/4c6d677b/9a9a6c77/4187132b/f46570573caa44fc90b6ead80e28d955?](https://media.edlio.net/4c6d677b/9a9a6c77/4187132b/f46570573caa44fc90b6ead80e28d955?CEQA_website)

Attachment D: [Responses to Comments](https://drive.google.com/file/d/1b2Lx08H8qzS55-paa4Dbx7GoGF4LE7Rq/view?usp=drive_link) <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1b2Lx08H8qzS55-paa4Dbx7GoGF4LE7Rq/view?usp=drive_link>

Linked materials of previously adopted Board reports referenced in the background and policy implications sections:

- Adopted December 23, 2023, [Board Report No. 130-23/24](https://media.edlio.net/827d2fb9/61a3613c/0347228f/595968c2ced443f5ad753f65bbd8ada1?_=2023-)
<https://media.edlio.net/827d2fb9/61a3613c/0347228f/595968c2ced443f5ad753f65bbd8ada1?_=2023-
- Adopted August 24, 2021, [Board Report No. 027-21/22](https://drive.google.com/file/d/1WJNvfI_ATG8VbpDx6KXq4_w2GxmSBNJA/view)
<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1WJNvfI_ATG8VbpDx6KXq4_w2GxmSBNJA/view>

Submitted:
02/12/26

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,



ANDRES E. CHAIT
 Acting Superintendent

APPROVED BY:



PEDRO SALCIDO
 Deputy Superintendent
 Business Services & Operations

REVIEWED BY:



DEVORA NAVERA REED
 General Counsel

APPROVED BY:



JAIME G. TORRENS
 Sr. Advisor to the Superintendent

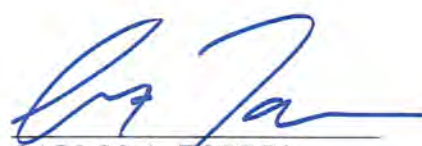
☒ Approved as to form.

REVIEWED BY:



KURT E. JOHN
 Deputy Chief Financial Officer

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:



CARLOS A. TORRES
 Director
 Office of Environmental Health &
 Safety

☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.



LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT Board of Education Resolution

RESOLUTION OF THE LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT BOARD OF EDUCATION ADOPTING THE MITIGATED NEGATIVE DECLARATION AND MITIGATION MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM FOR THE VALLEY OAKS CENTER FOR ENRICHED STUDIES MULTIPURPOSE ATHLETIC FIELD UPGRADES PROJECT

Whereas, on November 3, 2020, voters in Los Angeles Unified School District (Los Angeles Unified or District) passed Measure RR (School Upgrades and Safety Measure) as a funding mechanism to help address the significant and unfunded needs of LAUSD public school facilities; and

Whereas, under Measure RR and in conjunction with other, ongoing Los Angeles Unified Facilities programs, the District is proposing to upgrade, modernize, and replace aging and deteriorating District school facilities; update technology; and address District school facility inequities to provide students with physically and environmentally safe, secure, and updated school facilities supporting 21st century learning at hundreds of neighborhood schools District-wide; and

Whereas, On December 12, 2023, the Los Angeles Unified School District Board of Education (Board) approved the project definition for develop, design, and construct athletic field upgrades at Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies (VOCES) (Board Report No. 130-23/24) for a project budget of \$7,515,769; and

Whereas, the proposed Project is located on a 20.7-acre school campus at 9171 Telfair Avenue in the City of Los Angeles (Board District 6, Region North). The VOCES campus was originally established in 1960 as Richard E. Byrd Middle School, was then converted to Sun Valley High School in 2009, and finally re-opened in 2020 as the VOCES Magnet as a span school serving Grades 6-12. As of the 2025-26 Electronic Capacity Assessment Review (E-CAR), the school served approximately 443 students; and

Whereas, the proposed Project involves the modernization and enhancement of the existing multipurpose athletic field at VOCES. The proposed Project will demolish the existing asphalt pavement and handball courts and in its place, the proposed Project will construct a new natural grass turf regulation-size multipurpose athletic field, four new field lights up to 80 feet in height, goal posts, scoreboard, and five-tier portable bleachers to accommodate home and visiting team spectators for a seating capacity of approximately 370 seats. The proposed Project will also include restriping of an existing parking lot and minor upgrades to existing buildings and grounds consistent with the requirements Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA); and

Whereas, the site is not on any hazardous waste lists under Section 65962.5 of the Government Code. A site-wide Phase I ESA was conducted in 2006, and a PEA for Area B. The PEA-E did not identify any hazardous substances in the soil and Department of Toxic Substances Control (DTSC) issuing No Further Action was recommended for the site assessment investigation.

Whereas, the District's Office of Environmental Health & Safety (OEHS) evaluated the proposed Project to determine its potential impacts on the environment in accordance with CEQA, Public Resources Code §21000, et seq., and State CEQA Guidelines, Title 14 California Code of Regulations §15000 et seq.; and



LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

Board of Education Resolution

ATTACHMENT A

Whereas, environmental review of the Project found that there would be no significant impacts as a result of the construction and operation of the Project with the implementation of LAUSD Standard Conditions of Approval. This evaluation, as documented in the Initial Study (IS), resulted in the preparation of a Negative Declaration (ND) (State Clearinghouse Number 2025100439). The District circulated the IS/ND for a 30-day public review period from October 9, 2025, to November 10, 2025. Copies of the IS/ND were available for review electronically on the OEHS website and on the State Clearinghouse website and printed copies made available for public review at LA Unified School District Headquarters at Beaudry and at VOCES; and

Whereas, on October 9, 2025, the District filed the Notice of Intent to Adopt a Negative Declaration (NOI) pursuant to the requirements of CEQA, Public Resources Code §21000, et seq., and State CEQA Guidelines, Title 14 California Code of Regulations §15000 et seq.; and

Whereas, the District posted the NOI on the OEHS website during the public review period, mailed the NOI to all owner/occupants located within a 0.25-mile radius of the Project site, to parents/guardians of students, and published the NOI in two local newspapers (Daily News and La Opinión). The District filed the NOI with the Los Angeles County Clerk and with the State Clearinghouse for distribution to potentially affected state agencies, local agencies, tribal agencies pursuant to AB 52, and known interested parties; and

Whereas, the District responded to comments received during the public review period and at a community meeting in the Responses to Comments (RTC); and

Whereas, the District incorporated mitigation measures under tribal cultural resources as appropriate that were requested by the Fernandeano Tataviam Band of Mission Indians. Although these measures are not included to reduce an impact to less-than-significant, As a result of their addition of these mitigation measures, an MND, with the required MMRP, was prepared in place of the ND; and

Whereas, the District is the “Lead Agency” as defined in State CEQA Guidelines §§15050-15053, and the Board shall review and consider the MND and its supporting documents and comments.

Resolved, that the Board finds that:

The Project may not have an adverse effect on fish and wildlife, as referenced in §711.2 of the Fish and Game Code; and

The presumption of adverse effect set forth in California Code of Regulations, Title 14, §753.5(d) does not apply; and be it

Resolved further, that the Board hereby:



LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

Board of Education Resolution

ATTACHMENT A

1. Finds that the MND and MMRP were completed in compliance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines, as amended; and
2. Finds that the MND and MMRP reflect the District's independent judgment and analysis; and
3. Finds that the Board reviewed and considered the information in the MND and MMRP before making a decision to approve the Project; and
4. Adopts the MND and MMRP; and be it

Resolved further, that the Board specifies that the record of proceedings on which the Board's decision is based is located at the Los Angeles Unified School District, Office of Environmental Health and Safety, 333 South Beaudry Avenue, 21st Floor, Los Angeles, California, and the custodian of the record of proceedings is the Office of Environmental Health and Safety.

PASSED, APPROVED AND ADOPTED this 10th day of March 2026, by the following vote:

AYES:

NOES:

ABSENT:

ABSTAIN:

Michael McLean
Executive Officer of the Board of Education

Date